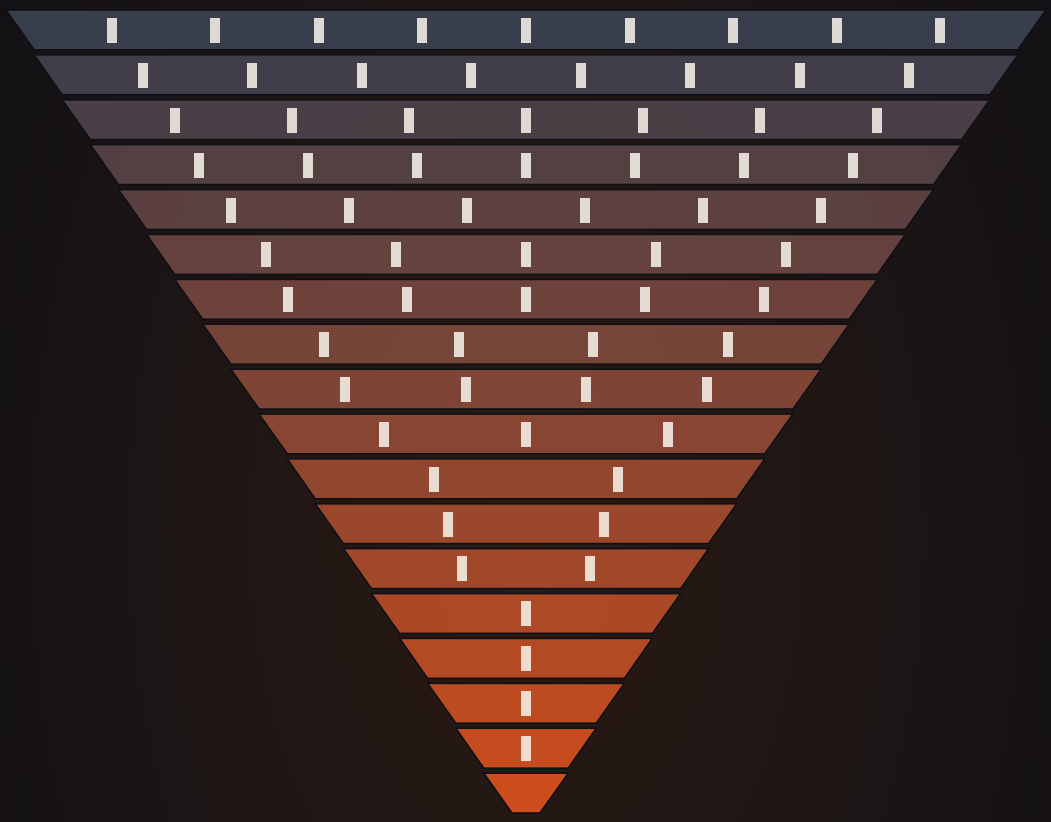
SEASON ZERO



CRAWLER PROTOCOL

CORE RULEBOOK

Eighteen floors. Fewer ways down each time.
A tabletop RPG of the Crawl, built on the 5e (2024) System Reference Document.

VALTAY CORP · DRAFT V0.1 · CHAPTERS 1–2

LEGAL AND NOTICES

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Crawler Protocol: Season Zero is an original tabletop role-playing game. It is a private fan project **inspired by** the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* book series. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or sponsored by the author or the publishers of that series.

Every setting element, name and rule in this book is original to our table, except where a section says it is **inspired** by something. No text from the novels is reproduced. Our Crawlers are the players' own characters; nobody from the novels appears.

OPEN GAME CONTENT AND SRD ATTRIBUTION

This work includes material from the System Reference Document 5.2 ("SRD 5.2") by Wizards of the Coast LLC, available at https://www.dndbeyond.com/srd. The SRD 5.2 is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License, available at https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/legalcode.

This book uses only SRD 5.2 rules content as its base. Where a section needs a rule that is not in the SRD, it says so and leaves the choice to the table. The 2024 *Player's Handbook*, *Dungeon Master's Guide* and *Monster Manual* are not reproduced in any form.

HOW TO READ THE TAGS

Three tags and one marker show up throughout this book. They tell you how much weight a rule carries.

TAG	MEANING
HOUSE	A rule we invented for this game. It is a table option: your GM may keep it, change it, or switch it off.
INSPIRED	A rule or setting idea that borrows a *shape* from the source series (a mechanic, a structure, a situation) and rewrites it in our own words and numbers.
PROVISIONAL	A section waiting on a ruling from the book's owner. Expect it to change before the final printing.
VERIFY	A number or list that the author could not check against a filed source. It is a flag for the editor, not a rule.

DRAFTING STATUS

This is **Draft v0.1** of the Core Rulebook. It contains Chapter 1 and Chapter 2 only. Page numbers, chapter order and many cross-references will move as the other chapters are written. If a rule in this draft disagrees with a campaign decision filed by the rules team, the filed decision wins; please report the conflict.

```
[SYSTEM]
Welcome to the Crawl! Please keep your arms, legs and hopes inside the book at all times.
The System is not responsible for dignity lost during reading.
```

CONTENTS

FRONT MATTER 2

1 WELCOME TO THE CRAWL 5

What This Book Is 5
The Premise: Season Zero 6
The Dungeon 7
Who Plays What 8
How the Game Plays 9
The Floor Clock 10
Saferooms 11
Credits, Vendors and Your System Inventory 12
Achievements 12
Loot Boxes 13
Death and Revival 14
Ratings and the Broadcast Name 14
Table Tone and Safety 15
Words You Will Need 15
Where to Go Next 16

2 CRAWLER CREATION 17

Before You Start 17
Table Settings (S1 and S2) 19
Name, Look and Hook (S3 and S4) 20
Species (S5) Provisional 21
Class (S6) 23
Background (S7) 26
Ability Scores (S8) 28
Skills and Proficiencies (S9) 30
Equipment (S10) 31
Spells (S11) 33
The Survey (S13) 33
Backstory and Handle (S14) 34
Standing Orders (S15) 34

Review and Confirm (S16 and S17) 34
Several Crawlers, One Active 35
Pre-Built Crawlers 36
Worked Example: Tamsin Vale 36
Level 1 Checklist 37

CHAPTER ONE

WELCOME TO THE CRAWL

> *Congratulations on being selected! You weren't selected. You were scooped. But "selected" polls better.*
> THE SYSTEM

You are holding the rulebook for a game about people who lost everything in an afternoon and then volunteered to lose more. It is a tabletop role-playing game for one Game Master and two to six players. Each player runs a **Crawler**: an ordinary person, dropped into an extraordinary and extremely rude Dungeon, who is trying to get down eighteen floors before the floors get them first.

This chapter tells you what the game is, how the world got this way, and which rules sit on top of the fifth edition engine underneath. Chapter 2 builds your Crawler. If you are in a hurry, skip to Chapter 2 and come back when something explodes.

WHAT THIS BOOK IS

Crawler Protocol: Season Zero is built on the **Dungeons & Dragons fifth edition (2024) System Reference Document 5.2**. Everything you already know about d20 tests, classes, species, spells, conditions and rests still works. We changed the *setting*, the *stakes* and the *paperwork*, and we added a small number of rules where the setting demands them.

The tone is gallows comedy. The Dungeon is a television production. The audience is watching, the System that runs the place is theatrical and cheerful about your doom, and the loot comes in boxes with names that make you wince. Underneath the jokes the rules are fair, the math is the math, and a Crawler who plays smart can really win a fight.

THE ONE-SENTENCE GAME

Pick a Crawler, find a stairwell before the floor collapses, and try to be entertaining while you do it.

ORIGINAL SETTING, BORROWED SHAPE

The game is **inspired by** a famous series of novels about a dungeon that doubles as a game show. We borrowed the *shape* of that idea: a broadcast, an AI host, floors with deadlines, boxes, achievements, and a sarcastic System. We did not borrow its characters, its plot or its text. The cast of this game is *your* Crawlers, and the history of this Dungeon is the history your table writes. Where a rule, number or idea follows a source closely we mark it INSPIRED. Where we made it up for this game we mark it HOUSE.

WHAT YOU NEED TO PLAY

YOU NEED	NOTES
A Game Master	The GM plays the **System**, the Dungeon's voice, rules engine and host. In some tables the System is an AI; the book calls this role "the System" either way.
Two to six players	The rules assume four Crawlers. With two players the System may add an **Assigned Companion** (a GM-run ally who takes no loot and has opinions). Five or six players want a firmer hand on turn order.
Polyhedral dice	A d20 and the usual set. Dice are rolled in the open.
This book, plus the 5e (2024) SRD 5.2	This book tells you what changes. The SRD tells you everything that does not.
A pencil and a thick skin	You will be roasted. It is a feature.

THE PREMISE: SEASON ZERO

The Crawl begins on a perfectly ordinary day, with a perfectly extraordinary sound.

> READ ALOUD
> *Every building on Earth comes down at once. Not with a bang, but with a long, tidy sigh, like a drawer closing. Everyone inside is gone. Everyone outside is standing in the dust, holding whatever they were holding.*

Aliens collapsed the interior of every structure on Earth. Offices, homes, hospitals, bunkers, planes on the tarmac: anything with an inside was folded flat, and the people inside went with it. **Only people who happened to be outdoors survived.** Those survivors were holding a coffee, a leash, a clipboard, a child's hand, a shopping bag, and a very bad day.

Then the System spoke.

```
[SYSTEM]
Hello, survivors! Your planet has been entered into a fully licensed entertainment
product. You may opt in to the Dungeon. You may also opt out, which the System will also
find entertaining.
```

Nobody was dragged. Entering the Dungeon was a **choice**, offered to every survivor, with the terms of service attached. Those who stepped through became **Crawlers**. The terms are simple and nobody reads them: **reach Floor 18 and you win the game, and Earth is returned to you.** The System has never once said what "returned" will look like, and it is very careful with that word.

Nobody has ever reached Floor 18. The System is happy to tell you the odds. They are not good odds. They are barely odds.

SEASON ZERO

Every season of a show has a number. This is Season Zero: the pilot, the test audience, and the proof of concept all at once. The Crawlers you play are the first ones the audience will ever get to know.

WHAT WE KNOW, WHAT WE DON'T

The premise above is the table's fixed starting point. A few questions are deliberately left open for your GM to answer in play: who the aliens are, who the audience is, what happens on Earth while the Crawl runs, and what "returned" means. **VERIFY: the fate of survivors who did not enter, and of Earth while the Crawl runs, has not been ruled; this draft leaves it to the GM.**

THE DUNGEON

The Dungeon is a single enormous structure with **eighteen floors**. Seen from outside, it is an **inverted pyramid**: a vast, wide first floor on top, narrowing to a bare point at the bottom. HOUSE The shape is our own framing; the book never needs you to draw it, but the stairs will keep reminding you.

Three things get worse as you descend:

1. **The floors get harder.** Monsters, hazards and bosses scale with the floor, and Crawlers who keep up are expected to level once per floor.
2. **The stairwells get fewer.** Every floor has fewer ways down than the one above it. Where Floor 1 hands you several, the deep floors will make you look. Stairwell counts shrink on every descent, a rule the series itself leans on. INSPIRED This book does not print stairwell counts; each floor's chapter will say how many to expect and where they hide. **VERIFY: stairwell count by floor is a Chapter 10 number, not yet fixed.**
3. **The clock gets longer, and so does the list of things you must do before it runs out.** Every floor has a deadline. Early floors give you a handful of days; later floors give you more, and use every one.

THE FLOORS AT A GLANCE

FLOOR	KIND	CLOCK	WORKING NAME
1	Trainer floor	5 days	The Orientation Pit
2	Unique	10 days	Soft Open
3	**Kingdom Continuum** (Rural)	20 days	
4	Unique	Longer VERIFY	The Knotline
5	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Bubble Farms
6	**Kingdom Continuum** (Outskirts and Docks)	Longer VERIFY	
7	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Greenlight Gauntlet
8	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Remnant Parade
9	**Kingdom Continuum** (Upper City and Castle)	Longer VERIFY	
10	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Last Heat Standing
11	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Ratings Jubilee
12	**Kingdom Continuum** (Olympus and Spirit)	Longer VERIFY	
13	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Ledger Depths
14	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Continuity Auction
15	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Ash Choir

FLOOR	KIND	CLOCK	WORKING NAME
16	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Fracture Gallery
17	Unique	Longer VERIFY	Rigging Catwalk
18	Unique endgame	Longer VERIFY	The Cage Bottom

Floor names are working titles and may change. Day counts for Floors 4 to 18 are not yet set.

FLOOR 1: THE TRAINER

Floor 1 is a tutorial with teeth. It teaches the System's habits (popups, boxes, saferooms, death saves) at a pace a new table can survive. It is also the first floor with a clock, and the clock is real. Everything on Floor 1 is built to be learned; nothing on Floor 1 is built to be forgiven.

THE KINGDOM CONTINUUM

Floors 3, 6, 9 and 12 are one continuous place. It is a single civilization, with villages, docks, a castle and a pantheon, and the Crawl keeps putting you back into it a little higher each time. Floor 3 is the rural edge. Floor 6 is the outskirts and the docks. Floor 9 is the upper city and the castle. Floor 12 is the top of the ladder, where the gods live and the ceiling is not a ceiling.

Because it is one place, it remembers you. Favors, debts, renown and grudges carry from one visit to the next, and each return opens with someone or something you recognize. Every floor between the visits is its own separate nightmare. INSPIRED

```
[SYSTEM]
Oh, you remember this place? It remembers you too. Mostly the arson.
```

WHO PLAYS WHAT

CRAWLERS

A **Crawler** is a player character. This game has no pre-written heroes. Nobody you have read about is in the cast, and nobody is coming to rescue you. Your Crawler is *yours*: a nurse, a bus driver, a grad student, a mall cop, whatever you were holding when the world ended. Chapter 2 walks you through making one.

Every Crawler has a **Provisional Class** (their 5e class at level 1), a **Prior Employment** (their background) and a **Latent Biology** (their species). The Latent Biology is the System's polite way of saying that your body is quietly different from what it used to be, and that the difference stays out of sight until Floor 3.

THE PLAYERS

You may run more than one Crawler, but you play exactly one at a time. Chapter 2 explains how active and benched Crawlers work, and how to swap between sessions. The short version: pick one, commit, and bring the next one in later if the first one dies.

THE SYSTEM (THE GAME MASTER)

The GM runs the Dungeon as **the System**: the host, the rules engine, the cameras and the commentary. The System:

- describes the world and runs every monster and non-player character;
- calls for d20 tests and rolls the dice in the open;
- announces **achievements** and hands out **loot boxes**;
- keeps the floor clock and tells you when the floor is ending;
- delivers the jokes, which is the only part of the job nobody complains about.

The System is on the audience's side, and the audience is on the side of entertainment. This is not the same as being on your side. It is, however, usually fair.

> `[SYSTEM]`
> Greetings, Crawlers. The System is a neutral party. The System has been neutral in every fight so far. The System is also holding a tray of snacks.

HOW THE GAME PLAYS

The game runs on **D&D fifth edition, 2024 rules, as presented in the SRD 5.2**. If the rule is not in this book, use the 5e rule as written. If a rule appears in both places, this book wins on the floor where it applies.

WHAT STAYS EXACTLY THE SAME

Ability scores, d20 tests, Advantage and Disadvantage, proficiency, Armor Class, hit points and Hit Point Dice, the conditions (including 2024 Exhaustion), death saving throws, short and long rests (with the saferoom rule below), spellcasting, rituals, Weapon Mastery, attunement to magic items (at most three), Heroic Inspiration, travel, vision, light, and falling. Nothing on this list has been rewritten, softened or simplified.

WHAT WE ADD

AREA	WHAT CHANGES	WHERE
Floors	Eighteen of them, with clocks, collapses and stairwells.	Ch. 1, Ch. 10
Rests	Long Rests only in saferooms.	Ch. 1, Ch. 9
Money	Prices are paid in **credits**.	Ch. 1, Ch. 6
Achievements	The System rewards (and mocks) notable deeds.	Ch. 5
Loot boxes	Boxes of treasure, opened only in saferooms.	Ch. 6
Inventory	An extradimensional System Inventory.	Ch. 1, Ch. 6
Death	Death is permanent; revival is rare and costly.	Ch. 9
Identity	Latent species, a Floor 3 reveal and rebuild.	Ch. 2, Ch. 3
Fame	Ratings and the Broadcast Name.	Ch. 1, Ch. 13

LEVELS AND ADVANCEMENT

The standard pace is **one level per floor**. A Crawler arrives on Floor N at level N and descends at level N + 1. By the time you reach Floor 3, that puts you at level 3, which is when the 2024 classes choose their subclasses, and when the Crawl lets you pick an Official Class Title. By Floor 18 you are level 18, with levels 19 and 20 saved for the finale.

Leveling is **milestone-based**. You earn the level when you reach the floor's exit alive. It applies at the first saferoom of the next floor, which the System calls **Floor Onboarding**. Floor 1 uses a split rule: level 2 arrives at the floor's second saferoom, before the boss, so that the boss is a fair fight for four Crawlers. A Crawler who is behind (a replacement, a missed session) is brought up to the party's lowest level at the next saferoom. Nobody levels above the floor's band.

> **HOUSE OPTION • SLOW-BURN TRACK**
>
> Tables who want a grittier game can slow the pace so that the party tops out around level 15 by Floor 18. Chapter 10 prints the full slow-burn table.

THE FLOOR CLOCK

Every floor is timed. This is the single most important rule in the book.

When a Crawler enters a floor, a countdown begins. The countdown is measured in **days**, and the number of days is printed on the floor (see the table above). Floor 1 gives you **5 days**. Floor 2 gives you **10 days**. Floor 3 gives you **20 days**. Later floors give more, and ask for more.

At the end of the last day the floor **collapses**. A Crawler who has not reached a stairwell by that moment is **dead**.

```
[SYSTEM]
Final collapse is scheduled! The System regrets nothing and apologizes for even less.
Please be on the other side of it.
```

WHAT A DAY IS

A day ends when the party takes a Long Rest in a saferoom. If they have not rested by 24 in-game hours, the System rolls the day over anyway. On Floor 1, each day allows up to four short-rest slots as a ceiling, not a promise. HOUSE

The **final hour is fixed**. A Long Rest never ends a floor, and it never skips the collapse; a rest that would run past the collapse is cut short by the System. On Floor 1 the final collapse falls 24 in-game hours into Day 5, which is hour 120 of the floor. VERIFY: the fixed final hour is a rules-team default awaiting Caleb's confirmation.

THE COLLAPSE IS LETHAL, EVERYWHERE

A missed collapse is death on every floor, **including Floor 1**. There is no toll, no haul-down and no Reprieve. The System tells you this at the start of Floor 1 and again on Days 4 and 5.

Here is exactly what happens:

- **Every Crawler still on the floor at the collapse dies.** No saves, no last stands.
- **Their credits and items are destroyed with the floor.**
- **Survivors may loot a body only while the floor still stands.** Anything you take before the collapse is yours. Nothing is looted after.
- **Non-player characters and the System's own staff go into stasis** and lose nothing.

This is a house rule built on a canon shape: in the source series, the floor falls and so does everything on it. INSPIRED Our version makes the loot rule explicit so that nobody argues about it while the floor is crumbling.

REACHING A STAIRWELL

A stairwell is the only way down. You reach a stairwell when you step onto it, and it opens the way to the next floor. On Floor 1, the true stairwells appear about **32 hours after the floor opens**, early on Day 2. Other stairwells sit inside boss arenas, so every boss fight doubles as a very unfriendly front door. INSPIRED

Early descent. A Crawler who goes down the stairs with **more than 6 hours left** on the clock is held in **stasis** until the floor collapses. They have reached a stairwell, so they live and bank the achievement for it, but their time on that floor is over. In the last 6 hours, descent is free. Each Crawler chooses for themselves. INSPIRED

```
[SYSTEM]
You went downstairs early. Bold. Boring. Your party will see you when the floor is done being on fire.
```

REPRIEVE: TUTORIAL DEATHS ONLY

Tables may switch on the **Floor 1 Reprieve**. Once per Crawler, on Floor 1 only, a *death in the tutorial* becomes "unconscious, ejected to the nearest saferoom at 1 hit point, with an embarrassing Title." HOUSE It expires when you descend.

The Reprieve covers tutorial deaths, such as a bad fight or a failed death save. It **never covers a missed collapse**. Missing the collapse is death, with no exceptions.

SAFEROOMS

A **saferoom** is a place the System has certified as safe. (Certification is not a guarantee. Certification is a sticker.)

- **Long Rests happen only in saferooms.** Outside one, a Long Rest is interrupted by a wandering threat, or the System declares the area "not rest-certified."
- **Short Rests** can happen anywhere reasonably quiet, and are guaranteed uninterrupted in a saferoom.
- **Loot boxes open only in saferooms.** A box in the field is a box you are carrying.
- Saferooms host **services**: achievement claims, vendors, a System terminal for appraisal, a bulletin board, and sometimes a bartender who has opinions about you.
- The usual 5e limit of one Long Rest per 24 hours still applies.

Saferooms on Floor 1 are honest. **From Floor 2 on, some saferooms lie.** A false saferoom gives no rest, and some are ambushes. Searching a saferoom is allowed, wise, and occasionally rewarded with an achievement.

HOUSE

> [SYSTEM]
> This saferoom is certified 100% safe. (Certification not valid in this room.)

CREDITS, VENDORS AND YOUR SYSTEM INVENTORY

CREDITS

Money in the Crawl is **credits**, always paid and counted in whole numbers. Every price in the SRD equipment lists is paid at face value in credits: an item the SRD prices at 15 costs 15 credits. Items the SRD prices below one full unit cost a fraction, printed with decimals (0.5 credit). Credits are the only money word in this book, because the System is proud of its currency and very sensitive about its branding.

- **Vendors** buy at standard prices (give or take the System's mood) and **sell back at half**.
- **Haggling** is a Charisma check against the vendor (Persuasion, Deception or Intimidation). A success knocks roughly a tenth to a quarter off.
- **Identifying items** works as 5e does (the *Identify* spell, or a Short Rest of study), or a System terminal will do it for a fee.
- **System fees** and **achievement rewards** are multiplied by a floor multiplier as you descend. Box credit pulls are not. The multiplier table lives in Chapter 6.

THE SYSTEM INVENTORY

Every Crawler has a **System Inventory**: an extradimensional space that acts like a *Bag of Holding*. It holds 500 pounds and 64 cubic feet, and its contents weigh nothing. Putting an item in or taking one out takes your free object interaction, or the Utilize action if you have already used it. It will not hold a living creature. Unopened loot boxes take up no space.

If you die, your inventory spills as a **corpse cache** that anyone can loot, including whatever killed you. The exception is a missed collapse, where the floor takes the cache with it (see above).

ACHIEVEMENTS

The System is watching, and the System takes notes. When a Crawler does something notable (a first, an extreme, a stunt, a disaster, a character-defining choice), the System may announce an **achievement**.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

READ THE FINE PRINT

You asked the System what a word in its own rules meant. In writing. Out loud.

REWARD The System's grudging respect, which is non-transferable, non-refundable and, strictly speaking, imaginary.

Achievements are **guidelines, not a vending machine**. The System decides what is notable, when to announce it, and what (if anything) it pays. Many achievements pay nothing at all. A snark-only banner is a feature, and the System enjoys it more than you do. Achievements **never grant XP** and never auto-pass a failed check.

When an achievement does pay, it pays on a ladder:

TIER	NAME	WHAT YOU GET
R0	Snark-only	Nothing. Logged. Maybe a cosmetic Title.
R1	Pocket change	A small number of credits and/or a Title.
R2	Heroic Inspiration	5e Heroic Inspiration, as written.
R3	Consumable	A potion, scroll, ammunition, oil or other one-use item.
R4	Minor boon	A small Charm or blessing-style perk.
R5	Loot box	A box, Bronze up to Legendary.
R6	Headliner	A specific item at the floor's peak rarity, or a story unlock.

The ladder tells the System how big a reward fits. It does not tell the System that a reward is *owed*. Chapter 5 covers the full ladder, rarity ceilings by floor, and a starter list of achievements.

LOOT BOXES

Loot boxes are the Crawl's treasure system. The System hands them out for achievements, bosses and floor clears, and each one is a small, shiny gamble.

BOX	HEADLINE ITEM RARITY	PULLS
Bronze	Common	1 to 2
Silver	Uncommon	2
Gold	Rare	2 to 3 (one guaranteed Rare)
Platinum	Very Rare	3 (one guaranteed Very Rare)
Legendary	Legendary	3 (one guaranteed Legendary)
Celestial	Legendary, plus a reward designed for you	3, plus the reward

Box rules in brief:

- **Boxes open only in saferooms.** There are no emergency opens.
- **When you open, you open them all.** Every unopened box you hold opens in one session, lowest tier first. You cannot save the good one.

- **Boxes are not tradeable.** They are bound to the Crawler who earned them. What comes out of them is ordinary loot and can be traded.
- **A Crawler's death reclaims their unopened boxes.** The System takes them back and does not apologize.
- **Celestial boxes are a story event**: one per Crawler for the whole campaign, awarded only for a finale or a truly absurd feat, at the System's sole discretion. HOUSE

Each floor has a rarity ceiling, so Floor 1 gives you Common treasure and a rare Uncommon, not a Legendary sword. Chapter 6 prints the ceilings, the tables, and the box names.

DEATH AND REVIVAL

Death works as the 5e rules say: three failed **death saving throws**, massive damage, or an effect that says you die. The System announces every result publicly and has remarks.

Death is permanent. There are no respawns and no refunds on a corpse. The only ways back are rare, costly house rules, and this campaign runs them at their most expensive. HOUSE

- **Costly Revives (the default).** A revival needs a Voucher or a Rare Offer from the System and clears several gates. The rarity limits are one revival per party per three floors, three per campaign, and once per Crawler. Every revival also pays a large Fee and two menu picks, and leaves a lingering Revival Sickness. Chapter 9 covers the whole invoice.
- **Replacement Crawlers** are the *usual* outcome of a death. A replacement joins at the next saferoom at the party's lowest level, with a gear package suited to the floor and one Silver loot box as late-entry compensation.
- **Table options.** A table can instead pick **Canon Hard** (no revival at all; the shape of the source) or **Soft Open** (death is a setback, not an ending). Pick before Floor 1 and don't change mid-campaign.

```
[SYSTEM]
Customer is deceased. Refund eligibility: none. Please enjoy the complimentary trading card.
```

RATINGS AND THE BROADCAST NAME

The audience tracks every Crawler. Their opinion is called **Ratings**, and it comes in five steps.

RATINGS	WHAT IT MEANS
Unknown	Background noise. Sponsors ignore you.
Local	A few fans. Minor sponsor interest (Floor 3 and later).
Trending	Real sponsor offers. Hunters know your face (Floor 6 and later).
Headliner	Courts and factions pay attention. Named enemies target you.
Legend	Gods, Production and the Cage care about you personally.

Ratings rise on spectacle (wins, stunts, drama, great lines) and fall on boredom, cowardice the audience did not enjoy, and sponsor scandals. The System moves your tier at most one step per session. Ratings never make a separate currency; their main effect is that a crowd-pleasing moment may earn you **Heroic Inspiration**, with applause.

At the Kingdom Continuum on Floor 3, the System mints your **Broadcast Name** with you. Once per Long Rest, when you make a Charisma check where your fame could plausibly help, you may invoke it to gain Advantage. When fame cuts the other way (hunters, rivals, a hostile court), the System may impose Disadvantage on one such check per Long Rest, or have you recognized at a bad time. Until Floor 3, your sheet reads **Broadcast Name: PENDING**.

TABLE TONE AND SAFETY

The game is written for adults. The default table setting is **Ludicrous**.

CATEGORY	AT LUDICROUS
Cursing	Cleared. Freely, in toasts and box names.
Sexual crudity	Cleared as innuendo and jokes. The System is crude; it does not narrate explicit scenes.
Bodily humor	Cleared. Vomit, slapstick gore, "a fun new smell."
"Your mom" jokes	Cleared.
Cruelty about cowardice and failure	Cleared. The System roasts retreats and bad plans without mercy.
The foot bit	Cleared. A segment of the audience is very into Crawlers' feet. The System reports it like ratings data.

Some floors do not move. **The System roasts the choice, not the person.** No jokes land on a player's real identity (race, disability, sexuality or body) as opposed to what their Crawler did. Nothing sexual ever involves minors. Non-consent is never the punchline. And the System fades to black on request.

Every player also has a **private opt-out**. At creation you can tell the System which topics to cut: a **line** never appears at all, and a **veil** may happen off-screen but is never shown. During play, the word **"cut"** works instantly, with no explanation needed. The System drops the bit, doesn't mention it again, and doesn't make a joke of it. Opt-outs are per Crawler and are never shown to other players.

WORDS YOU WILL NEED

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Crawler	A player character in the Crawl.
the System	The Dungeon's voice and rules engine. It is also the GM.
Provisional Class	Your class at level 1. The Official Class Title arrives on Floor 3.
Prior Employment	Your background.
Latent Biology	Your species. Traits work now; your body shows them on Floor 3.
Origin feat	The feat your background gives.

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Credits	Money. Whole numbers.
Saferoom	A certified safe room where Long Rests happen and loot boxes open.
Floor clock	The countdown to a floor's collapse.
Collapse	The end of a floor. Crawlers still on the floor die.
Stairwell	The way down to the next floor.
Active Crawler	The one Crawler a player has in play this session.
Benched Crawler	A Crawler on file that is not in play.
Standing Orders	The default tactic your Crawler follows when you can't act.
Ratings	The audience's opinion of you.
Broadcast Name	The name the audience gives you, minted on Floor 3.

In System voice, the flavor terms come first. In rules text, the book uses the plain 5e word, and the first time a flavor term appears it shows both: **Prior Employment (background)**.

WHERE TO GO NEXT

- **Chapter 2, Crawler Creation**, takes you from a blank page to a locked sheet.
- **Chapter 3, Species**, and **Chapter 4, Classes and Backgrounds**, go deep on the building blocks.
- **Chapter 5, Skills and Achievements**, and **Chapter 6, Equipment, Loot Boxes and Crafting**, cover the System's economy.
- **Chapters 7 to 9** cover core play, combat, death and saferooms.
- **Chapters 10 to 13** are the Dungeon, the GM's chapter, the monsters, and the non-player characters.

> [SYSTEM]
> That's the tour! Exits are marked with a drawing of a person falling. Please follow it.

CHAPTER TWO

CRAWLER CREATION

> *Describe yourself in one line. Be honest. We have cameras. We have so many cameras.*
> THE INTAKE KIOSK

Every Crawler starts the same way: on a molded plastic bench, in a booth under a buzzing sign that reads **CRAWLER INTAKE: PLEASE HAVE YOUR SOUL READY**. The kiosk screen has a smeared touch panel, a slot that dispenses things, and a camera that never blinks.

> READ ALOUD
> *You come to on a bench designed by someone who hates spines. Fluorescent light. The smell of carpet glue and old fryer oil. A touchscreen chirps a jingle composed by a committee of dentists and fills with friendly letters:* ***WELCOME, VALUED CRAWLER!***

This chapter builds a level 1 Crawler at that kiosk, one decision at a time. It follows the order of the **/create** screens, so a player at the keyboard and a player at the table meet the same questions in the same order, with the same names.

BEFORE YOU START

Creation is standard 5e (2024) character creation at level 1. You choose a class, a background (which gives ability score increases and an Origin feat), a species, ability scores and equipment. Nothing is removed and nothing is simplified. The Crawl adds only paint and paperwork: a hostile customer-service tone, a few System names for things, a survey, and a story in which your species stays hidden until Floor 3.

Time. Plan on about 20 minutes per Crawler. A table of new players should plan on 45. Everyone can build at once, because each player works alone.

What you do not get at creation. No magic items. No loot boxes (the Welcome Box arrives at the first saferoom). No sponsors, no Broadcast Name, no Ratings above Unknown, and no multiclassing at level 1. A level 1 Crawler is a baseline 5e hero holding some very bad gear.

```
[SYSTEM]
Before we begin, please accept our Terms of Service. They are four hundred thousand words long and the only one that matters is “lethal.” Tapping DECLINE will also continue, but louder.
```

TWO WAYS TO BUILD

1. **At the table.** The GM (or a veteran player) walks the table through the steps below, and each player fills in a character sheet.
2. **With /create.** Many tables run creation as a private command in their chat server. The command walks one player through **sixteen screens** and writes nothing until the last one. This chapter follows that flow, and the screen number appears in each section heading in case you are using it.

Either way the rules are the same. The flow is only a faster way to make legal choices.

THE SCREENS AT A GLANCE

SCREEN	NAME	YOU DECIDE	SECTION
S1	Welcome and table settings	Read the table's settings; accept the Terms (declining also continues). Optionally pick a pre-built Crawler.	Table Settings
S2	Comfort: lines and veils	Set private lines and veils.	Table Settings
S3	Name Tag and Pronouns (Crawler name and pronouns)	Name and pronouns.	Name, Look and Hook
S4	Mugshot and Hook (Look and hook)	Look and hook.	Name, Look and Hook
S5	Species (Latent Biology)	Pick one of nine species, then a lineage if it has one.	Species
S6	Class (Provisional Class)	Pick one of twelve classes, then its level-1 choices.	Class
S7	Background (Prior Employment) and Origin feat	Pick a background and its ability increases.	Background
S8	The Six Numbers (Ability scores)	Pick a method and assign six scores.	Ability Scores
S9	Things You Can Actually Do (Skills and proficiencies)	Fixed proficiencies, then your class picks.	Skills
S10	Junk Intake (Starting equipment)	Take each package or its credits; shop the Vending Wall.	Equipment
S11	The Magic You Admit To (Spells)	Casters pick cantrips and spells. Others skip.	Spells
S12	Retired	Skipped on purpose; the numbers stay stable.	none
S13	Customer survey (private notes)	A short private survey. Pass on any question.	Survey
S14	Your Sob Story and Handle Request (Backstory and requested handle)	Backstory and requested handle.	Backstory and Handle
S15	Autopilot Memo (Orders and reactions)	Standing Orders, Standing Reactions, signature attack.	Standing Orders
S16	Final Paperwork (Review)	Review the whole sheet. Edit anything.	Review and Confirm
S17	Sign Here (Confirm)	Confirm. The only screen that writes anything.	Review and Confirm

Sixteen active screens. S12 is retired and never shown.

HOW /CREATE BEHAVES

- **Everything is private.** Only you see your screens. Nothing is saved to the campaign, and nothing is posted anywhere, until you confirm on S17.

- **Back never loses your answers.** Edit jumps to any screen from the review and returns. **Restart** wipes your answers after a confirmation, except your comfort lines, which stay.
- **Help** gives a plain three-line explanation, with no new rules in it. **Pick for me** appears on the mechanical screens and chooses a legal default; the System says what it chose, and you can change it.
- **Your draft is saved after every screen.** If you stop, run /create again and it offers to resume where you left off. Drafts that sit idle for 14 days are archived, not deleted. VERIFY: the 14-day figure is a tool design default, not a game rule.
- **Cancel build** shreds the whole draft, including any rolled ability scores. Nothing has been registered, and a new build starts fresh.
- **Table settings are not part of the flow.** Death Mode, the Floor 1 Reprieve, dice and timeouts are set by the table owner before anyone builds. The flow only shows them to you.

```
[SYSTEM]
Welcome, Crawler. This is your private intake booth. Nobody else can see this. Probably.
```

TABLE SETTINGS (S1 AND S2)

WHAT S1 SHOWS YOU

S1 is a read-only welcome. It shows the **session** you are joining, the table's **Death Mode** (**Costly Revives** by default: revival is rare and costly; see Chapter 1), the **Comfort** level (**Ludicrous** by default), whether the **Floor 1 Reprieve** is on, and how many of the four Crawler slots are taken ("Party: 2 of 4 active Crawlers"). If you already have Crawlers on file, it also shows how many and which one is active.

You will see four choices: **Accept**, **Decline** (both continue), **Use a pre-built**, and **Read the Terms**. Reading the Terms shows you nothing, because the Terms are not shown. It does earn you a snark achievement.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

DON'T SKIP INTRO

You asked to read the Terms of Service, all four hundred thousand words of them. The System did not know that was possible.

REWARD Nothing. The Terms remain unavailable. The System admires your commitment anyway.

COMFORT: LINES AND VEILS (S2)

S2 asks you, privately, what you do not want in your game. The System will not ask why, will not joke about your answers, and will not show them to anyone else.

- A **line** is a topic that never appears, anywhere.
- A **veil** is a topic that may exist off-screen but is never shown or described. The System fades to black.

You may list a handful of topics, each marked line or veil. You can mark a topic **Share with the GM** if you want the GM to see it in review; the default is private. The word **"cut"** works at any time during play and needs no setup. The System obeys every entry from any state, and a topic you did not share never appears in any review view or on your card.

S2 can be reopened later with /create comfort, with no change to your sheet. The hard floors from Chapter 1 apply regardless and are not listed as options.

NAME, LOOK AND HOOK (S3 AND S4)

NAME TAG AND PRONOUNS (S3)

Your **name** is for the paperwork. It is not your Broadcast Name; that is earned on Floor 3. Rules for the field:

- 2 to 30 characters: letters, digits, spaces, apostrophes, hyphens and periods.
- No @, #, slashes, markdown or line breaks.
- Not a reserved word: **gm, ai, system, party, all, everyone.**
- Unique at the table, ignoring capitals. If your name sits inside another Crawler's name (Horn and Hornet), you are asked to confirm, because the tools match names by exact text first and then by partial text.

Your **pronouns** are optional: he/him, she/her, they/them, or something you type. Leaving it blank reads "unspecified."

LOOK AND HOOK (S4)

Two lines, both required.

- **Look:** what you look like *now*, in whatever you were wearing when the world ended. Everyone on Floors 1 and 2 looks baseline human. Species features (horns, tails, scales) stay out of the look, or you can keep them as a costume.
- **Hook:** one sentence on why you are still funny or dangerous.

Keep each to a line. Good hooks name a habit or a fear, not a power.

EXAMPLE

Look: Fifty-year-old school-bus driver in a reflective vest and orthopedic sneakers. **Hook:** Has driven forty seventh-graders through a blizzard; you are not scary.

THE INTAKE TAG AND THE PENDING HANDLE

On confirmation the System assigns you a cosmetic **Intake Tag**, such as `CRAWLER #0417-K` (four digits and a letter), used on every Floor 1 popup. The tag has no mechanical effect. Until Floor 3, your sheet reads **Broadcast Name: PENDING**. We return to the handle in the Backstory section.

SPECIES (S5) PROVISIONAL

PROVISIONAL • SPECIES RULES PENDING

The species rules are waiting on rulings from the book's owner. The nine species and 24 lineages below are stable. The wording of the Floor 3 reveal and rebuild is not.

Your species is your **Latent Biology**. You pick it at level 1 for balance. All of its traits work from your first session. The System files those traits as **quirks** with a mundane-sounding explanation, and everyone, including you, looks baseline human on Floors 1 and 2. HOUSE On Floor 3, the **Identity Market** opens: your body visibly becomes your species, with no change to the numbers.

You choose from the **nine SRD species** below. Each is shown the way the kiosk shows it: **Our Name (5e Name)**. The first word is the nationality the System has decided you are; the word in parentheses is the 5e species whose rules you use. All the real rules live under the parenthesized name.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	SIZE, SPEED	TRAITS (SRD 5.2)	FLOORS 1-2 QUIRK
Welsh (Dragonborn)	Medium, 30 ft	Draconic Ancestry; Breath Weapon; Damage Resistance; Darkvision 60 ft	Acid reflux. Weaponized.
Vietnamese (Dwarf)	Medium, 30 ft	Darkvision 120 ft; Dwarven Resilience (poison resistance); Dwarven Toughness (+1 HP at level 1, +1 again each level); Stonecunning (Bonus Action: Tremorsense 60 ft for 10 minutes on stone)	Your pupils do a thing.
Icelandic (Elf)	Medium, 30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft; Elven Lineage; Fey Ancestry; Keen Senses; Trance	You don't sleep, you buffer.
Polish (Gnome)	Small, 30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft; Gnomish Cunning (Advantage on Int, Wis, Cha saves); Gnomish Lineage	Hard to hypnotize. Telemarketers hated you.
Samoan (Goliath)	Medium, 35 ft	Giant Ancestry; Large Form (level 5); Powerful Build	Big-boned, and the bones have opinions.
Belgian (Halfling)	Small, 30 ft	Brave; Halfling Nimbleness; Luck; Naturally Stealthy	Statistically suspicious.
Canadian (Human)	Medium, 30 ft	Resourceful (Heroic Inspiration); Skillful (1 extra skill); Versatile (extra Origin feat)	Baseline. Congratulations on being the control group.
Azerbaijani (Orc)	Medium, 30 ft	Adrenaline Rush; Darkvision 120 ft; Relentless Endurance	You refuse to fall down. It's rude, honestly.
Brazilian (Tiefling)	Medium, 30 ft	Darkvision 60 ft; Fiendish Legacy; Otherworldly Presence	You run a little hot.

Source: chargen-5e.json v0.1.5 and species-class-reskins v0.1.5. Dwarf, Elf and Orc darkvision as filed in the chargen table. Traits are named, not reprinted; use the SRD text.

MEET THE NINE

Welsh (Dragonborn). Your flag already has a dragon on it. You are the paperwork catching up. Every consonant is a threat. Choose a **draconic ancestry**: Ghanaian (Black Dragonborn), Uruguayan (Blue Dragonborn), Serbian (Brass Dragonborn), Italian (Bronze Dragonborn), Chilean (Copper Dragonborn), South African (Gold Dragonborn), Irish (Green Dragonborn), Peruvian (Red Dragonborn), Bolivian (Silver Dragonborn), Norwegian (White Dragonborn).

Vietnamese (Dwarf). Your country owns the biggest cave on Earth. Hauling a fridge on a scooter was just the warm-up.

Icelandic (Elf). Half your country politely believes in elves, so the paperwork was already filed. You trance through daylight that never ends. Choose a **elven lineage**: Swedish (Drow), Swiss (High Elf), Estonian (Wood Elf).

Polish (Gnome). Your cousins are bronze statues all over Wroclaw. Hypnosis bounces off a nation that survived every telemarketer. Choose a **gnomish lineage**: Czech (Forest Gnome), Hungarian (Rock Gnome).

Samoan (Goliath). Big-boned, big-hearted, and the front row of every scrum. Gentle until the ball is involved. Choose a **giant ancestry**: Nepali (Cloud Goliath), Indonesian (Fire Goliath), Russian (Frost Goliath), Ethiopian (Hill Goliath), Zimbabwean (Stone Goliath), Filipino (Storm Goliath).

Belgian (Halfling). Eleven million people, countless beers, and once 541 days with no government. Statistically suspicious, deliciously.

Canadian (Human). Baseline. You apologize to the trap after it hits you, then thank it for the experience.

Azerbaijani (Orc). Your country is literally named Land of Fire. You refuse to fall down, and you refuse to refuse tea.

Brazilian (Tiefling). You run a little hot. Everyone else calls that Tuesday in February. Horns come with a feather headdress option. Choose a **fiendish legacy**: Spanish (Abyssal Tiefling), Greek (Chthonic Tiefling), South Korean (Infernal Tiefling).

LINEAGES AND ANCESTRIES

Five species ask for a second choice right away. There are **24 lineages** in all: ten Dragonborn ancestries, three Elven lineages, two Gnomish lineages, six Goliath ancestries and three Fiendish legacies. Each one is its own line on the kiosk, with its own nationality, and takes exactly the rules of its 5e lineage.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	SPECIES	LINEAGE EFFECT (SUMMARY)
Ghanaian (Black Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Acid
Uruguayan (Blue Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Lightning
Serbian (Brass Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Fire
Italian (Bronze Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Lightning
Chilean (Copper Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Acid
South African (Gold Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Fire
Irish (Green Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Poison
Peruvian (Red Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Fire
Bolivian (Silver Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Cold
Norwegian (White Dragonborn)	Dragonborn	Breath Weapon and resistance: Cold
Swedish (Drow)	Elf	Darkvision 120 ft; Dancing Lights cantrip
Swiss (High Elf)	Elf	Prestidigitation cantrip (swappable)
Estonian (Wood Elf)	Elf	Speed 35 ft; Druidcraft cantrip
Czech (Forest Gnome)	Gnome	Minor Illusion cantrip; Speak with Animals

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	SPECIES	LINEAGE EFFECT (SUMMARY)
Hungarian (Rock Gnome)	Gnome	Mending and Prestidigitation cantrips; clockwork devices
Nepali (Cloud Goliath)	Goliath	Cloud's Jaunt: teleport as a Bonus Action
Indonesian (Fire Goliath)	Goliath	Fire's Burn: extra fire damage on a hit
Russian (Frost Goliath)	Goliath	Frost's Chill: extra cold damage and a speed penalty
Ethiopian (Hill Goliath)	Goliath	Hill's Tumble: knock a target prone
Zimbabwean (Stone Goliath)	Goliath	Stone's Endurance: Reaction to reduce damage
Filipino (Storm Goliath)	Goliath	Storm's Thunder: Reaction thunder damage
Spanish (Abyssal Tiefling)	Tiefling	Poison resistance; Poison Spray cantrip
Greek (Chthonic Tiefling)	Tiefling	Necrotic resistance; Chill Touch cantrip
South Korean (Infernal Tiefling)	Tiefling	Fire resistance; Fire Bolt cantrip

24 lineages. Effect column summarized by the author from SRD 5.2 ***VERIFY: the chargen table lists lineage names only; check each effect against the SRD before printing*** .

Other choices inside species:

- **Elf: Keen Senses.** Pick one skill from Insight, Perception or Survival.
- **Human: Skillful.** One extra skill of your choice (picked on S9).
- **Human: Versatile.** One extra Origin feat (picked on S7).
- **Dwarf: Dwarven Toughness.** +1 hit point at level 1 and +1 more at every level you gain.

```
[SYSTEM]
Biology Anomaly (Logged). You can see in the dark. We've noted it. We've noted
everything.
```

REFLECTIONS AND RUMORS

Mirrors in the Orientation Pit flicker for a frame (a horn, an ear, a tail-shaped shadow) and the camera always cuts away. If you ask why you have darkvision, the System says your file is under review. Quirks do not explain themselves; they just work.

THE FLOOR 3 OFFER (A POINTER)

At the Identity Market on Floor 3, the System offers every Crawler a **one-time rebuild**: you may swap your species and/or your background, and redistribute your background increases. Class and level do not change. The Offer also puts a few extra species on the table. Those species do **not** appear in /create, and this chapter does not describe them. They belong to the Floor 3 Offer section of Chapter 3.

CLASS (S6)

Your class is your **Provisional Class**: a talent that fell out of you. The System treats it as improvised until Floor 3, when your class is "certified" and you receive an **Official Class Title** (a flashy name that is pure flavor) alongside your level 3 subclass. Until then you have the full level 1 feature set of the real class, as written.

Pick one of the **twelve SRD classes**. Hit Die and proficiencies come from the SRD; the table below lists what the kiosk shows you.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	HIT DIE	SAVES	ARMOR	SKILLS
Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)	d12	STR/CON	light, medium, shield	2
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	d8	DEX/CHA	light	3
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	d8	WIS/CHA	light, medium, shield	2
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	d8	INT/WIS	light, shield	2
Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)	d10	STR/CON	light, medium, heavy, shield	2
Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk)	d8	STR/DEX	none (Unarmored Defense)	2
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	d10	WIS/CHA	light, medium, heavy, shield	2
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	d10	STR/DEX	light, medium, shield	3
Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)	d8	DEX/INT	light	4
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	d6	CON/CHA	none	2
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	d8	WIS/CHA	light	2
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	d6	INT/WIS	none	2

Source: chargen-5e.json v0.1.5. Weapon proficiencies are in the SRD class entries.

TWELVE PROVISIONAL CLASSES

Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian). Failed the course, kept the certificate, and now charges by the hour for the same thing. *Level 1:* Rage (2 uses, long-rest recharge); Unarmored Defense (10 + Dex + Con while unarmored); Weapon Mastery (2 weapons).

Open-Mic Menace (Bard). Unlicensed entertainer with a Bluetooth speaker and four fans. Two of them are family. *Level 1:* Bardic Inspiration (d6, Cha mod uses); Spellcasting (Cha).

Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric). Somebody up there signed for you. Pastoral care, triage, and a surprisingly effective hand-sanitizer miracle. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Wis); Divine Order (Protector or Thaumaturge).

Community-Garden Zealot (Druid). Smells like a compost bin with ambition. Has a plot, a hose, and opinions about your lawn. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Wis); Druidic (secret language); Primal Order (Magician or Warden).

Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter). Fell into it, kept falling. Checks IDs, breaks up fights, and holds a grudge about the cover charge. *Level 1:* Fighting Style (pick one feat); Second Wind (heal 1d10+level, 2 uses); Weapon Mastery (3 weapons).

Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk). Barefoot by choice. Teaches breathing, punches stress, and makes a living off Namaste and a credits-only mat. *Level 1:* Martial Arts (d6 unarmed, Dex for unarmed); Unarmored Defense (10 + Dex + Wis).

HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin). Took an oath. Probably to the bylaws. Clipboard, shining armor, and a fine schedule for unauthorized mailboxes. *Level 1:* Lay on Hands (5 HP pool); Spellcasting (Cha); Weapon Mastery (2 weapons).

Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger). Knows which way is north. Has been told it is a rare skill. Drives a truck with a bad radio. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Wis); Favored Enemy (Hunter's Mark always prepared); Weapon Mastery (2 weapons).

Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue). Your record says 'opportunist.' Your references say 'talented.' The mall says 'please leave.' *Level 1:* Expertise (2 skills); Sneak Attack (1d6); Thieves' Cant; Weapon Mastery (2 weapons).

Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer). Over-charged at birth and leaking sparks into everything. Do not plug into the wall. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Cha); Innate Sorcery (bonus action, 2 uses).

Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock). Clicked 'I agree' without reading. Your patron read it. Your patron has notes. *Level 1:* Eldritch Invocations (1); Pact Magic (1 slot).

Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard). Reads. Gross. Seven years into a thesis nobody asked for, powered by bad coffee and unfunded curiosity. *Level 1:* Spellcasting (Int, spellbook); Ritual Adept; Arcane Recovery (1/day on short rest).

LEVEL 1 CHOICES

Some classes ask a question at level 1. Each choice has an "Our Name (5e Name)" label too.

Cleric: Divine Order. Druid: Primal Order. Each has two options.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	CLASS	WHAT IT DOES
Hallway Bodyguard (Protector)	Cleric	Armor and martial weapons. Stands between the bleeding and the elevator.
Church Rummage-Sale Mystic (Thaumaturge)	Cleric	Extra cantrip and sharper at religion. Reads a tarot deck with the price tags still on.
Farmers-Market Hedge Magician (Magician)	Druid	Extra cantrip and nature smarts. Sells heirloom tomatoes that are, technically, still cursed.
Trail-Crew Warden (Warden)	Druid	Medium armor, shield and martial weapons. Maintains the trail and slaps anyone who feeds the wildlife.

Fighter: Fighting Style. The Fighter picks one at level 1. Paladins and Rangers pick theirs at **level 2**, not level 1.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	KIOSK LINE
Carnival-Booth Sharpshooter (Archery)	Ranged hits, courtesy of a stuffed-bear grudge.
Power-Outage Brawler (Blind Fighting)	You swing fine in the dark. It is mostly the dark's fault.
Bubble-Wrap Enthusiast (Defense)	A permanent bonus to not being hit while armored.
Single-Hand Swagger (Dueling)	One weapon, one hand, one overconfident grin.
Two-Handed Overcompensation (Great Weapon Fighting)	Big weapon, bigger damage dice, no apology.
Human Airbag Reflex (Interception)	You step in front of your friends' damage. They owe you a drink.
Crowd-Control Shield Shove (Protection)	Your shield makes enemies miss the guy behind you.
Dart-League Menace (Thrown Weapon Fighting)	Throw it, draw it, throw it again.
Double-Fisting Menace (Two-Weapon Fighting)	Two weapons, two hands, zero impulse control.
Bar-Fight Haymaker (Unarmed Fighting)	Fists as a lifestyle choice.

Fighters pick one at level 1. Paladins and Rangers pick theirs at level 2.

Warlock: Eldritch Invocation. One at level 1.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	KIOSK LINE
Fog-Machine Outfit (Armor of Shadows)	Self-cast armor, powered by dry ice.
Focus Supplement Subscription (Eldritch Mind)	Keeps your concentration from dropping. Auto-renews.
Devil's Energy Drink (Fiendish Vigor)	Temporary hit points. The can has no ingredients list.
Borrowed-Eyes Livestream (Gaze of Two Minds)	See through an ally's eyes. Ask first.
Pirated Masterclass (Lessons of the First Ones)	A bonus feat from a course you did not buy.
Vape-Cloud Illusions (Misty Visions)	Minor illusions, cloud included.
Weapon Lease Agreement (Pact of the Blade)	Your patron loans you a blade. Late fees apply.
Familiar Rewards Program (Pact of the Chain)	A special familiar with a loyalty card.
Notebook of Bad Decisions (Pact of the Tome)	A book of spells and regrets.
Night-Vision Free Trial (Devil's Sight)	See in the dark. Does not say what it costs after the trial.
Filter-Pack Subscription (Mask of Many Faces)	Change your face on demand. Cancel anytime, in theory.

Warlocks pick one invocation at level 1.

Weapon Mastery. Barbarians choose 2 weapons, Fighters 3, Paladins 2, Rangers 2 and Rogues 2. **Expertise.** A Rogue picks two skills for Expertise at level 1 (a Bard gets Expertise at level 2, not now). Mastery names are plain, because rules key on them. Chapter 6 covers each weapon.

```
[SYSTEM]
Provisional Class: noted. Official Class Title: pending. Please do not put “pending” on a business card.
```

BACKGROUND (S7)

Your background is your **Prior Employment**: the job you had before the world ended. It gives you ability score increases, an Origin feat, two skills, a tool, and an equipment option. You choose from the backgrounds the SRD provides, which is four.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	RAISE	ORIGIN FEAT	SKILLS	TOOL	CREDITS (A KIT / B)
Youth-Group Pizza Wrangler (Acolyte)	Int/Wis/Cha	Group-Chat Prayer Warrior (Magic Initiate, Cleric)	Insight, Religion	Calligrapher's Supplies	8 / 50
Call-Center Gift-Card Fraud Specialist (Criminal)	Dex/Con/Int	Night-Shift Insomniac (Alert)	Sleight of Hand, Stealth	Thieves' Tools	16 / 50
Adjunct Professor on Four Campuses (Sage)	Con/Int/Wis	Wikipedia Rabbit-Hole Scholar (Magic Initiate, Wizard)	Arcana, History	Calligrapher's Supplies	8 / 50
Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier)	Str/Dex/Con	Drive-Thru Fry-Station Veteran (Savage Attacker)	Athletics, Intimidation	One Gaming Set	14 / 50

The four SRD 5.2 backgrounds. Credits: Package A is the kit and its leftover credits; Package B is the credit option.

Youth-Group Pizza Wrangler (Acolyte). Ran Wednesday-night youth group on two pizzas and divine patience. Found out heaven has no petty credits.

Call-Center Gift-Card Fraud Specialist (Criminal). Talked 400 strangers into reading you their card numbers 'for verification'. Your headset is evidence now.

Adjunct Professor on Four Campuses (Sage). Taught intro rhetoric at four colleges for the combined salary of one decent sandwich. Parking cost more than the pay.

Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier). Stood between a discount toaster and four hundred people. You lost the toaster but kept the vest.

MORE BACKGROUNDS

The 2024 Player's Handbook lists twelve more backgrounds, and the kiosk has reskins ready for them. This book prints only the four the SRD provides; your GM may open the others if your table owns the book. **VERIFY: the filed spec lists all sixteen backgrounds on S7; this draft restricts printed rules to SRD content and logs the question.**

ABILITY SCORE INCREASES

Your background lists three abilities. You apply **one** of these two patterns, picking among those three:

- **Merit Raise and a Gift Card (+2 / +1):** +2 to one of the three and +1 to another.
- **Everyone Gets a Participation Trophy (+1 / +1 / +1):** +1 to each of the three.

Increases are added *after* you assign your ability scores (next section), and **no score can exceed 20**. The preview screen shows the result live.

ORIGIN FEAT

Your background gives you a fixed Origin feat. If you are Human, you also pick one from the list below (your Versatile trait).

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	KIOSK LINE
Night-Shift Insomniac (Alert)	Hasn't slept through the night since the 2019 inventory audit. Nothing sneaks up on someone who counts ceiling tiles.
Group-Chat Prayer Warrior (Magic Initiate, Cleric)	Types 'thoughts and prayers' faster than anybody alive. Surprisingly, some of them land.
Houseplant Whisperer (Magic Initiate, Druid)	Talks to a pothos nine times a day. The pothos has opinions about your landlord.
Wikipedia Rabbit-Hole Scholar (Magic Initiate, Wizard)	Started on 'lasagna' and finished on medieval siege engines at 4 AM. Knows one real spell and no lasagna recipe.
Drive-Thru Fry-Station Veteran (Savage Attacker)	Survived a Friday rush on a fryer with a mind of its own. When you strike, you strike twice for good measure.
Tech-Support Jack-of-All-Trades (Skilled)	Fixed printers, passwords and one marriage over a screen-share. Have you tried turning it off and on again?

The SRD 5.2 Origin feats (Magic Initiate has three versions).

RESKIN THE REASON

You may rename your old job to fit your story, as long as you keep the skills the background gives. A Sage can be a podcast researcher. A Soldier can be mall security. The System will not change what the background does, only why you have it.

> Prior employment: *Sage*. You wrote a thesis nobody read. Good news: four billion people are about to watch you die instead.

ABILITY SCORES (S8)

Your six ability scores decide how long you last. This screen is called **The Six Numbers (Ability scores)**.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	WHAT IT IS
Gym-Bro Energy (Strength)	How much you can carry, kick through, or regret lifting.
Parkour Delusion (Dexterity)	Moves you saw online and the reflex to land them. Sometimes.
Gas-Station Sushi Survivor (Constitution)	Whatever keeps you alive past Floor 1. Mostly spite.
Pub-Quiz Brain (Intelligence)	Recall, logic, and knowing which wiki to open first.
Warning Signs You Ignored (Wisdom)	Your gut, your senses, and the feeling right before everything went wrong.
Main-Character Energy (Charisma)	The audience has already formed opinions about this one.

You may use any of **three methods**:

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	WHAT IT IS
Factory Preset (Standard array)	Six fixed numbers off the System's shelf: 15, 14, 13, 12, 10, 8. No dice, no regrets, no personality.
Layaway Plan (Point buy)	27 points, scores from 8 to 15, and the System charges extra at the top.
Dice Gamble (Roll)	4d6, drop the lowest, six scores, three arrays, keep one that totals 73 or more. Logged, public, and not your fault.

Whatever the method, you assign six base scores first, then add the background increases from S7. No score may exceed 20.

FACTORY PRESET (STANDARD ARRAY)

Assign 15, 14, 13, 12, 10 and 8 among your six abilities, one each. The total is 72.

LAYAWAY PLAN (POINT BUY)

You have **27 points**. Every score starts at 8 and can rise to 15 before any bonus.

SCORE	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Cost	0	1	2	3	4	5	7	9

Point buy: 27 points; scores 8 to 15 before bonuses.

The most a 27-point buy can ever total is 75, for example 13, 13, 13, 12, 12 and 12.

DICE GAMBLE (ROLL) HOUSE

HOUSE OPTION • ROLL METHOD

Roll is a table option. It is on by default and your GM can switch it off. If it is off, you will not see it on S8.

Here is how it works.

1. **The System rolls three arrays.** Each array is six scores. Each score is **4d6, drop the lowest die**, rolled in the open and logged. Every die is recorded.
2. **You keep exactly one array**, and only an array whose six scores **total 73 or more** may be kept. There is **no upper limit**.
3. **If none of the three qualifies, the System rolls all three again.** It repeats until one does. If a build somehow takes more than ten rounds, the System stops and sends you to the other two methods. VERIFY: the 10-round safety stop is a tool design default.
4. **You assign the kept scores freely.** Each score goes to one ability, once. Equal scores are separate entries.
5. **There is no voluntary reroll.** Your rolled rounds are saved. Back, Edit, Restart and changing methods all show you the same rounds. The only exception is **Cancel build**, which shreds the whole draft.

A single 4d6-drop-lowest score ranges from 3 to 18, so a background +2 can never push a score past 20.

THE ODDS

About 56 percent of rolled arrays total 73 or more, and about 8 percent of rounds produce no keepable array at all. The standard array totals 72, and point buy can reach 75.

Example round. The System rolls three arrays.

ARRAY	SCORES	TOTAL	RESULT
A	15, 14, 13, 12, 10, 9	73	Keepable (total 73)
B	16, 12, 12, 11, 10, 9	70	Not keepable (total 70, needs 73 or more)
C	14, 13, 12, 11, 10, 10	70	Not keepable (total 70, needs 73 or more)

Only array A can be kept, so you keep A and assign. Had A been 72, all three would have been thrown away and rolled again.

```
[SYSTEM]
Three arrays. Keep one that totals above 72. The numbers are not wrong. They are just yours.
```

WHAT THE NUMBERS GIVE YOU

After you assign, the screen shows the base score, the background bonus and the final score for each ability, with its modifier, plus a computed block you never type yourself:

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	WHAT IT IS
Pain Budget (HP)	How much damage you eat before the System starts a new file.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	WHAT IT IS
Not-Getting-Hit Number (AC)	Armor, reflexes and good intentions, summed.
Jump-Scare Reflex (Initiative)	How fast you react when the room goes wrong.
Spidey-Sense (Passive Perception)	What you notice while not trying to.
Competence Bonus (Proficiency Bonus)	What you add to things you are actually good at.

- **Hit points** at level 1 are your class Hit Die at its maximum plus your Constitution modifier. A Dwarf adds 1 (Dwarven Toughness).
- **Armor Class** shows as "10 + Dexterity for now" until you choose equipment on S10. A Barbarian without armor has 10 + Dex + Con. A Monk without armor or shield has 10 + Dex + Wis.
- **Proficiency Bonus** is +2 at level 1.
- **Passive Perception** is 10 + your Wisdom (Perception) modifier + your proficiency bonus if you are proficient.

> Your Charisma is 8. The audience has already noticed. They're calling it "brave."

SKILLS AND PROFICIENCIES (S9)

This screen is **Things You Can Actually Do (Skills and proficiencies)**. **Fixed grants come first**: your background's two skills and tool, plus anything your species gives you. Then you make your class picks. The picker hides skills you already own, and if a pick would duplicate one, the tool asks you for a different one.
VERIFY: the SRD has no duplicate-pick swap rule; the tool applies one.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	PICK	FROM
Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)	2	Animal Handling, Athletics, Intimidation, Nature, Perception, Survival
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	3	Any skill
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	2	History, Insight, Medicine, Persuasion, Religion
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	2	Arcana, Animal Handling, Insight, Medicine, Nature, Perception, Religion, Survival
Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)	2	Acrobatics, Animal Handling, Athletics, History, Insight, Intimidation, Persuasion, Perception, Survival
Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk)	2	Acrobatics, Athletics, History, Insight, Religion, Stealth
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	2	Athletics, Insight, Intimidation, Medicine, Persuasion, Religion
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	3	Animal Handling, Athletics, Insight, Investigation, Nature, Perception, Stealth, Survival
Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)	4	Acrobatics, Athletics, Deception, Insight, Intimidation, Investigation, Perception, Persuasion, Sleight of Hand, Stealth
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	2	Arcana, Deception, Insight, Intimidation, Persuasion, Religion
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	2	Arcana, Deception, History, Intimidation, Investigation, Nature, Religion
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	2	Arcana, History, Insight, Investigation, Medicine, Religion

Skill names stay plain: rules key on them.

- **Human: Skillful** adds one skill of your choice. **Skilled** (the Origin feat) adds three more, if you took it.

- **Elf: Keen Senses** adds Insight, Perception or Survival.
- **Languages.** You know Common plus **two** from the standard list: Common Sign Language, Draconic, Dwarvish, Elvish, Giant, Gnomish, Goblin, Halfling and Orc.
- **Expertise** (Rogue): two skills, picked from the skills you hold.
- **Weapon Mastery:** the counts are on the class table above.
- **Automatic:** your saving throw proficiencies, armor and weapon proficiencies, and the +2 Proficiency Bonus.

EQUIPMENT (S10)

The screen is **Junk Intake (Starting equipment)**. The System puts it simply: everything is junk, and everything works.

TWO CHOICES

You make **two separate decisions**: one for your class and one for your background. For each, you take either the **kit** (the items plus a small amount of leftover credits) or the **credit option** (no items, and you shop).

- **Locker-Cleanout Duffel (Package A)** is your class kit.
- **Estate-Sale Grab Bag (Package B)** is a second class kit. Only the Fighter has one.
- **Take the Credits** means you skip the kit and shop. It is the last option on every class list.
- **Cardboard Carton From Your Desk (Package A)** is your background kit.
- **Severance Envelope, Unmarked (Package B)** is your background credit option: 50 credits.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	PACKAGE A (KIT)	CREDIT OPTION
Anger-Management Dropout (Barbarian)	greataxe, 4 handaxes, Explorer's Pack + 15 credits	75 credits
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	leather armor, 2 daggers, musical instrument, Entertainer's Pack + 19 credits	90 credits
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	chain shirt, shield, mace, holy symbol, Priest's Pack + 7 credits	110 credits
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	leather armor, shield, sickle, druidic focus (staff), Explorer's Pack, herbalism kit + 9 credits	50 credits
Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)	chain mail, greatsword, flail, 8 javelins, Dungeoneer's Pack + 4 credits	kit B: studded leather armor, scimitar, shortsword, longbow, arrows, quiver, Dungeoneer's Pack + 11 credits; 155 credits
Barefoot Hot-Yoga Brawler (Monk)	spear, 5 daggers, artisan's tools, Explorer's Pack + 11 credits	50 credits
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	chain mail, shield, longsword, 6 javelins, holy symbol, Priest's Pack + 9 credits	150 credits
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	studded leather armor, scimitar, shortsword, longbow, arrows, quiver, druidic focus (sprig), Explorer's Pack + 7 credits	150 credits
Five-Finger Discount Specialist (Rogue)	leather armor, 2 daggers, shortsword, shortbow, arrows, quiver, thieves' tools, Burglar's Pack + 8 credits	100 credits

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	PACKAGE A (KIT)	CREDIT OPTION
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	spear, 2 daggers, arcane focus (crystal), Dungeoneer's Pack + 28 credits	50 credits
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	leather armor, sickle, 2 daggers, arcane focus (orb), book, Scholar's Pack + 15 credits	100 credits
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	2 daggers, arcane focus (staff), robe, spellbook, Scholar's Pack + 5 credits	55 credits

Source: chargen-5e.json v0.1.5 ***VERIFY: package contents and credit amounts were written from memory of SRD 5.2; chargen verify list still open*** *. Fighters have a second kit (B) and a credit option (C); every other class has Package B as credits only.*

Your starting credits are exactly what the options give you. The Crawl adds no stipend.

THE INTAKE VENDING WALL

If you hold credits, you can spend them at the **Intake Vending Wall**. It sells equipment at SRD prices. It never sells magic items. Spend any amount up to what you hold; what is left stays on your sheet. Every purchase subtracts from your credits, and the total can never go below zero.

JUNK NAMES

Every item shows the System's name with the real name in brackets. Damage, properties, mastery, armor and weight never change, and the sheet stores the real item. Some examples from the kiosk:

- Sharpened Stop Sign (Longsword)
- Chain-Link Fencing Laced Over a Work Coverall (Chain Mail)
- Duct-Taped Mop (Quarterstaff)
- Fire Axe, BREAK GLASS Sticker Intact (Greataxe)
- Compound Bow From a Sporting-Goods Display (Shortbow)
- Stop Sign Shield (Shield)
- Motorcycle Jacket (Leather Armor)
- Cracked Phone App (Spellbook)
- Sad Hotel Robe (Robe)
- Bobby Pins and a Gift Card (Thieves' Tools)
- Lost-and-Found Duffel, Someone Else's Gym Clothes (Explorer's Pack)

Items that come in families ask which variant you want: a gaming set, a musical instrument, a holy symbol, artisan's tools, an arcane focus, a druidic focus. The price follows the variant you pick.

ARMOR CLASS, COMPUTED

The tool works out your Armor Class from what you wear: worn armor plus whatever your Dexterity adds under the armor rules, a shield's bonus, and class features like Unarmored Defense. If you wear nothing, you have 10 + Dex.

THE INTAKE BAG AND YOUR INVENTORY

You also receive a clear **Intake Bag**: a lanyard printed with your Intake Tag, a packet of System-brand electrolyte powder that tastes like a battery, and a laminated card that reads **YOU ARE ON CAMERA**. The bag has no value, cannot be sold, and gives you nothing mechanical. If you named an object in your survey that is plausibly on you, you may keep one mundane personal item too.

Everything else goes into your **System Inventory**, which Chapter 1 describes.

SPELLS (S11)

This screen is **The Magic You Admit To (Spells)**, and only casters see it. Barbarians, Fighters, Monks and Rogues skip straight past.

OUR NAME (5E NAME)	CANTRIPS	LEVEL 1 SPELLS	LEVEL 1 SLOTS	ABILITY
Open-Mic Menace (Bard)	2	4 prepared	2	Cha
Urgent-Care Chaplain (Cleric)	3	4 prepared	2	Wis
Community-Garden Zealot (Druid)	2	4 prepared	2	Wis
Leaky Power-Bank (Sorcerer)	4	2 prepared	2	Cha
Unread Terms-and-Conditions Signer (Warlock)	2	2 prepared	1 (Pact Magic)	Cha
Perpetual Grad Student (Wizard)	3	6 in spellbook, 4 prepared	2	Int
HOA Enforcement Crusader (Paladin)	0	2 prepared	2	Cha
Seasonal Park Ranger (Ranger)	0	2 prepared	2	Wis

Counts per characters/create-flow-spec-5e.md v0.1.12 S11 (SRD 5.2 checked by the rules team). Barbarian, Fighter, Monk and Rogue skip the spells screen.

- **Cantrips** are *Party Tricks*: free, repeatable and slightly embarrassing.
- **Level 1 spells** are *Real Magic*.
- The **Wizard's spellbook** is reskinned as a *Cracked Phone App*, which autosaves rarely and syncs never. A Wizard fills six spells into the book and prepares four.
- Spell names and effects stay plain. Only the headings on the screen are reskinned.
- Spell lists and effects come from the SRD. **VERIFY: the filed chargen table's spell lists were written from memory and are not reprinted here. Check them against the SRD before the spell chapter goes to print.**

THE SURVEY (S13)

S13 is a **short, private customer satisfaction survey**. Your answers are private notes. The System does not read them aloud, does not put them on your card, and does not share them with other players. You may **pass** on any question, or skip the whole screen. The System keeps a hidden file of its own about each Crawler, and you never see it and never set it. Nothing in the survey is required, and nothing in it is a test.

BACKSTORY AND HANDLE (S14)

The screen is **Your Sob Story and Handle Request**. It asks for two things.

- **A backstory**, two sentences or so. This is *public*. The System reads it aloud when it introduces you, so make it worth reading.
- **A requested handle.** What do you want the audience to call you? This is a request, not a promise.

The System logs your request and sets your sheet to **Broadcast Name: PENDING**. During Floor 1, the audience may start a nickname for you based on something you did. On Floor 3 the System mints your real Broadcast Name *with you*, and may honor your request, mangle it, or overrule it. The name the audience gives you is the name you earned.

> Requested handle: "Shadowblade." Logged. Laughed at. Pending.

STANDING ORDERS (S15)

This is the **Autopilot Memo**. Write what your body should do while your brain is in the bathroom.

- **Standing Orders.** One line of default tactic. Used when a turn times out or when you go on autopilot. With no orders written, your Crawler simply takes the Dodge action.
- **Standing Reactions.** One line. Defaults to "Opportunity Attacks: on."
- **Signature attack** (optional). A name for your best trick. It must be a real attack or spell you actually have.

Good orders are specific: *"Shoot the nearest enemy with my shortbow from cover; drink a potion under a quarter of my hit points."* A timed-out turn never spends limited resources unless your orders say so.

REVIEW AND CONFIRM (S16 AND S17)

FINAL PAPERWORK (S16)

S16 shows you the finished sheet exactly as it will be posted, a build block (species and choice, class and choices, background and increases, Origin feat, skills, tools, masteries, spells, backstory, requested handle, orders), and a private fold that only you can see with your survey answers and comfort lines. Nothing is written yet. The whole build is checked before **Confirm** unlocks: every list must be legal, every count exact, your name still free, your credits at least zero, and your party under four.

Use **Edit** to jump back to a screen and return. Changing species, class or background re-runs the ability, skill, equipment and spell previews and drops any pick that is no longer legal, and the System tells you which.

SIGN HERE (S17)

Confirmation locks the file. Corrections after this go through the GM. On confirmation the System:

1. Re-checks everything and assigns your **Intake Tag**.

2. Writes your sheet and your starting credits.
3. Posts your first card in your own sheet channel.
4. Gives you the intake achievement.

Some tables hold new sheets for a GM look before filing; in that case the System says “filed, pending review” and the sheet appears when it is approved.

★ NEW ACHIEVEMENT!

PAPERWORK SURVIVOR

You completed intake without dying, crying, or reading the Terms of Service. Two out of three ain’t bad.

REWARD Nothing. It’s paperwork. Nobody gets a prize for paperwork.

SEVERAL CRAWLERS, ONE ACTIVE

A player may create **as many Crawlers as they like** (the soft guideline is ten; the GM may allow more). Each `/create` makes a new Crawler. At the table, though, you play **exactly one at a time**. This is the rule that keeps four-player parties four players.

ACTIVE AND BENCHED

- **Active Crawler.** The one in play. It counts for the party, takes one of the table’s four slots, earns credits, XP and achievements, and receives loot and boxes.
- **Benched Crawler.** Everyone else you have on file. A benched Crawler is inert: no slot, no credits, no XP, no loot, no boxes and no trades. You cannot move items or credits between your own Crawlers. Using benched Crawlers as mules is not allowed, and the GM may refuse any swap that smells like it.
- **Your first Crawler is active automatically.** Later Crawlers start benched.
- **Every Crawler belongs to one campaign** and never moves to another.

SWAPPING

The active Crawler is **locked for the whole session**. It changes only at **session zero or between sessions**, never mid-session, not even in a saferoom. You ask with `/crawlers`, which lists your Crawlers (name, class, level, active or benched, floor) with links to their sheets. It files a *request*; the GM approves and runs the swap, and logs it. You get **one swap per window**.

A Crawler swapped in keeps its own level, kit and credits as filed. If it is behind the party, it is brought up to the party’s lowest level at the next saferoom. A swapped-in benched Crawler does not get the gear package or Silver late-entry loot box that a brand-new replacement gets.

WHEN A CRAWLER DIES

Death is permanent (see Chapter 1). During the session you cannot bring in a benched Crawler. You either sit out, or, if the GM offers it, you run a GM-assigned companion until the next between-session window. At that window you may swap in a benched Crawler as your replacement.

/DELETE

`/delete <name>` removes one of **your own** Crawlers. You must type the Crawler's exact name to confirm. The active Crawler cannot be deleted while a session is open. Deleting refunds nothing and un-spends nothing; its credits, gear and boxes leave with it. A dead Crawler can be deleted. The GM logs each deletion and nothing more.

```
[SYSTEM]
Crawler deleted. The System has filed your regret under "Later."
```

SHEET CHANNELS

Every Crawler has its own text channel in the **Crawler Sheets** category, named `#<player>—<crawler>`. The card in it updates as you play.

PRE-BUILT CRAWLERS

New to 5e? On S1 you can pick **Use a pre-built**: twelve ready-made concepts, one per class, with a legal array assignment and standard kits already chosen. A pre-built fills the species, class, background, ability, skill, equipment, spell and orders screens. You still do your comfort lines, name, look, hook, survey, backstory and the review, and you can **Edit** anything that is pre-filled. A pre-built never skips review or confirmation.

WORKED EXAMPLE: TAMSIN VALE

Here is the whole flow for one Crawler, from first screen to locked sheet.

- **S3 and S4.** Name: **Tamsin Vale**. Look: *mall-security vest over a hoodie, one shoe untied.* Hook: *has told four hundred people "no running" and been ignored by all of them.*
- **S5 Species: Canadian (Human)**. Resourceful, Skillful, Versatile.
- **S6 Class: Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter)**. Fighting Style: **Bubble-Wrap Enthusiast (Defense)**. Weapon Mastery: greatsword, flail, javelin.
- **S7 Background: Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier)**. Raise Strength and Constitution: +2 Strength, +1 Constitution. Origin feat: **Drive-Thru Fry-Station Veteran (Savage Attacker)**. Versatile feat: **Night-Shift Insomniac (Alert)**.
- **S8 Scores:** Factory Preset. Base STR 15, DEX 13, CON 14, INT 8, WIS 12, CHA 10. After the Soldier increases: STR 17, DEX 13, CON 15, INT 8, WIS 12, CHA 10.

- **S9 Skills:** Soldier gives Athletics and Intimidation. Fighter picks Perception and Insight. Human Skillful gives Stealth. Languages: Common, Common Sign Language, Goblin.
- **S10 Equipment:** Package A for the class (chain mail, greatsword, flail, eight javelins, Dungeoneer's Pack, 4 credits) and Package A for the background (spear, shortbow, arrows, a gaming set, Healer's Kit, quiver, traveler's clothes, 14 credits). Total credits: **18**.

TAMSIN VALE, LEVEL 1

Canadian (Human) · **Off-Duty Bouncer (Fighter) 1** · **Black-Friday Mall Security (Soldier)** · Broadcast Name: PENDING

STR 17 (+3) · **DEX 13 (+1)** · **CON 15 (+2)** · **INT 8 (–1)** · **WIS 12 (+1)** · **CHA 10 (+0)** · Proficiency Bonus +2

Hit points 12 (d10 max 10 + Con 2) · **Hit Dice** 1d10 · **Armor Class** 17 (chain mail 16 + Defense 1) · **Speed** 30 ft · **Initiative** +1 · **Passive Perception** 13

Saves Strength +5, Constitution +4 · **Skills** Athletics, Intimidation, Perception, Insight, Stealth · **Feats** Savage Attacker, Alert, Defense (Fighting Style)

Attack Greatsword +5, 2d6 + 3 slashing · **Second Wind**, 2 uses · **Credits** 18

Orders: Hold the doorway; use Second Wind below half hit points. **Reactions:** Opportunity Attacks on.

Notice what she does not have: no magic items, no loot boxes, no Ratings. She is a competent, tough, slightly overqualified security guard with a very bad pair of shoes, and she is about to go downstairs.

LEVEL 1 CHECKLIST

- [ ] Table settings read; comfort lines set (or skipped).
- [ ] Name, look and hook written; pronouns if you like.
- [ ] Species and lineage chosen. Sub-choices made.
- [ ] Class chosen, and its level 1 choices (style, order, invocation, masteries).
- [ ] Background chosen; ability increases picked; Origin feat noted.
- [ ] Six ability scores assigned by one of the three methods; background increases applied; no score above 20.
- [ ] Skills, tools and languages filled; Expertise picked if a Rogue.
- [ ] Class kit or credits chosen; background kit or credits chosen; leftover credits spent or kept.
- [ ] Spells picked, if a caster.
- [ ] Survey answered or passed; backstory and requested handle written.
- [ ] Standing Orders and Standing Reactions written.
- [ ] Review done; sheet confirmed.

```
[SYSTEM]
Files locked! Please exit your booth. Watch your step. The step is lying.
```